MICHAEL DENTON, MBA

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Summary

Director of Baseball Operations at Eastern Illinois University. Build catcher and pitcher reports from TrackMan and Pitch AWRE data, including a custom framing model and season catcher log. Former college pitcher who competed internationally against European national teams, with experience coaching, recruiting, and running team operations.

Work Experience

Athletic Department, Eastern Illinois University

Director of Baseball Operations **January 2026 – Present**

- Serve as Video Manager for TrackMan, TruMedia, and Synergy, handling day-to-day operation of technology, troubleshooting, and data management.
- In charge of all TrackMan and Pitch AWRE data for the program (15 pitchers); create post-outing reports for pitchers and catchers.
- Develop and coach 5 catchers, focusing on skill development, game strategy, and performance improvement.
- Assist with pitching staff development and individualized programming.
- Serve as Data Input Manager for game statistics and detailed catching metrics, including pop times, receiving, and blocking.
- Assist with midweek scouting reports on opposing hitters.
- Serve as Dugout Coach and Bullpen Manager, overseeing pre-game operations, gameday radar guns, and dugout-to-bullpen communication.
- Coordinate online recruiting and recruiting calls, creating reports on prospective student-athletes; assist with showcases.
- Manage travel food budgeting, meal planning, and receipts for 14 road trips with a 50-person travel party.
- Support daily program operations, including home plate field maintenance, NCAA bat testing, practice and pregame setup, and the program golf outing.

Projects (Project links may be requested)

Catcher Analytics and Reports Platform, Eastern Illinois University **January 2026 – Present**

- Charted every scrimmage and game and built an R-based catcher analytics platform from the charting data.
- Built a web app that turns TrackMan CSV files into catcher reports and keeps a season log for each catcher, with exports to Google Sheets and Excel.
- Created a called-strike model from 1,282 taken pitches to measure strikes above average (SLAA) and framing runs, with a framing leaderboard and pitcher-catcher pair breakdowns.
- Returning catcher improved clean-catch rate from 66.5% to 85.6% and blocking from 42.9% to 82.7% from spring to fall; group average pop time improved from 2.18 to 2.08 seconds.

KLAW Pitching Program, Eastern Illinois University **January 2026 – Present**

- Built an individualized pitching program for all 15 pitchers, accessible from any phone or computer.
- Used daily by pitchers; programming is updated weekly with the pitching coach in Google Sheets and syncs to the app live.

Pitching and Catching Post-Outing Reports, Eastern Illinois University **January 2026 – Present**

- Create post-outing reports for pitchers and catchers after games and scrimmages using TrackMan and Pitch AWRE data.
- Catcher reports cover framing (strikes gained and lost, zone and shadow strike %, results by hitter side), missed calls, pop times, exchange times, throw accuracy, and balls in the dirt.
- Built a pitcher outing log tracking 83 fall outings across 15 pitchers, including first-pitch strike %, race to two strikes, whiff %, chase %, fastball velocity, and contact quality.

Transfer Portal Scouting Board, Eastern Illinois University **May 2026 – Present**

- Built a scouting board tracking 3,000+ D1, D2, and D3 transfer portal players with performance scores and tiers, minimum-sample rules, and CSV export.

Athletic Department Staff, Rosemont College

Assistant Athletic Director, Compliance Coordinator, Student Success Coordinator **July 2025 – January 2026**

- Oversaw NCAA compliance for five varsity sports, including eligibility, recruiting, amateurism, and playing/practice seasons.

- Managed eligibility certification for 122 student-athletes and 72 transfer evaluations after the College discontinued athletics.
- Developed and conducted NCAA rules education for over 60 student-athletes, coaches, and staff; investigated and reported potential violations to the conference office and NCAA.
- Supervised budgets, scheduling, and resources for six varsity sports.
- Served as Game Day Administrator and departmental Title IX Officer.

Head Junior Varsity Baseball Coach and Varsity Pitching Coach **August 2024 – January 2026**

- Recruited and mentored student-athletes, supporting their athletic and academic success.
- Cultivated a positive team culture focused on sportsmanship, teamwork, and academic success, and enforced team policies aligned with College and Program values.
- Created and maintained a comprehensive Pitchers' Handbook to support player development and consistency across the program's 26 pitchers.
- Monitored academic progress and eligibility of 22 junior varsity players.
- Oversaw daily maintenance and operations of off-campus baseball facilities.

Athletic Operations **August 2024 – July 2025**

- Managed scheduling for 14 NCAA-sponsored sports across teams, facilities, and academic calendars.
- Directed operations for 74 home athletic events per year, including facility setup, staff and vendor coordination, and emergency protocols.
- Coordinated team transportation, game contracts, and game official logistics in compliance with NCAA regulations.
- Recruited, trained, and supervised 28 Federal Work Study students as game day staff and team managers.

Athletic Operations and Sports Information – Graduate Assistant **August 2023 – May 2024**

- Updated the Rosemont Athletics website, including rosters, statistics, and contest scores.
- Managed social media content, statistics, and player highlights using BOXOUT Sports and Sidearm.
- Produced 70 live streams a season for all 14 teams using OBS; managed the YouTube page.

Education

Master of Business Administration; Certificate in Strategic Leadership **May 2024**

Bachelor of Science in Sport Management **May 2023**

Rosemont College, Rosemont, PA

Honors: Dean's List, 2021-2022; Colonial States Athletic Conference All-Academic Honors; Kistler Honor Society

Associate of Arts in Business **May 2021**

Prairie State College, Chicago Heights, IL

Honors: Phi Theta Kappa Honor Society

Playing Experience

Pitcher, Rosemont College (NCAA Division III) **2021 – 2024**

- Team captain; set the school single-season pitching appearance record with 21 in 2023; 2024 Coaches' Award recipient.
- Mentored underclassmen players.

Pitcher, Prairie State College (NJCAA) **2019 – 2021**

International Competition **2022, 2025**

- Competed against the national teams of the Czech Republic, Spain, and Greece at Prague Baseball Week (2022).
- Played in the Finkstonball Tournament in Austria and the Bravo Cup in Zagreb, Croatia (2025).

Leadership Experience

President and Conference Representative, Rosemont Student-Athlete Advisory Committee **August 2022 – May 2024**

- Revived a dormant committee after a two-year hiatus by establishing a new executive board and drafting a revised constitution.
- Attended the 2023 and 2024 NCAA Conventions, representing the Colonial States Athletic Conference, United East, and Rosemont College.

Skills and Certifications

Driveline Foundation of Pitching Certificate, TrackMan, Pitch AWRE, R, Synergy, TruMedia, HUDL, NCAA Manager, NCAA Apps, RefQuest Plus, Sidearm Sports, BOXOUT Sports, Presto Sports, Gipper, OBS, Canva, Microsoft Office Suite, G Suite